



YOUR GROUP INSURANCE PLAN BENEFITS

**AMERICAN EMPLOYERS ALLIANCE
STD**

The enclosed certificate is intended to explain the benefits provided by the Plan. It does not constitute the Policy Contract. Your rights and benefits are determined in accordance with the provisions of the Policy, and your insurance is effective only if you are eligible for insurance and remain insured in accordance with its terms.

The Guardian Life Insurance Company of America

10 Hudson Yards
New York, New York 10001
(212) 598-8000
www.GuardianAnytime.com

If Your Group Certificate includes any of the following coverages: Guardian Insured: Group Accident, Group Cancer, Group Critical Illness, Group Hospital Indemnity, Group Dental or Group Vision, the following consumer complaint notice is applicable. (Employer Funded Coverages, if any, are excluded from this Rider.)

New Mexico Residents
Consumer Complaint Notice

If You are a resident of New Mexico, Your coverage will be administered in accordance with the minimum applicable standards of New Mexico law. If You have concerns regarding a claim, premium, or other matters relating to this coverage, You may file a complaint with the New Mexico Office of Superintendent of Insurance (OSI) using the complaint form available on the OSI website and found at:

<http://www.osi.stat.nm.us/ConsumerAssistance/index.aspx>

CCN-2019-NM

B999.0042

CERTIFICATE OF COVERAGE

The Guardian Life Insurance Company of America

*10 Hudson Yards
New York, New York 10001
(212) 598-8000*

The group Short Term Disability income coverage described in this Certificate is attached to the group Policy effective January 1, 2021. This Certificate replaces any Certificate previously issued under this Policy or under any other plan providing similar or identical benefits issued to the Policyholder by Guardian.

In the event of a conflict or discrepancy between the Vermont certificate and a non-Vermont group policy, the Vermont Certificate will govern.

GROUP SHORT TERM DISABILITY INCOME COVERAGE

Guardian certifies that the Employee to whom this Certificate is issued is Eligible for the coverage, and in the amount, described herein. In order to be eligible for coverage, the Employee must: (a) satisfy all of the Policy's eligibility and Effective Date requirements; (b) be listed in Our and/or the Policyholder's records as a validly covered Employee under the Policy; and (c) all required premium payments must have been made by or on behalf of the Employee; and (d) satisfy any necessary Proof of Insurability requirements.

The Employee is not covered by any part of the Policy for which he or she has waived coverage. Such a waiver of coverage is shown in Our and/or the Policyholder's records.

Policyholder: AMERICAN EMPLOYERS ALLIANCE
Group Policy Number: 00569928

The Guardian Life Insurance Company of America



Michael Prestileo, Senior Vice President

THIS CERTIFICATE DOES NOT MEET THE MINIMUM COVERAGE REQUIREMENTS OF THE AFFORDABLE CARE ACT. YOU SHOULD NOT PURCHASE THIS CERTIFICATE UNLESS YOU ARE ALREADY COVERED BY COMPREHENSIVE MAJOR MEDICAL INSURANCE.

B400.7758

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GENERAL PROVISIONS

Applicable Benefits

This Certificate may include multiple benefit options and types of benefits. You will only be covered for benefits if:

- They were previously selected in an acceptable manner and mode, such as an enrollment form or other required form; and
- We have received any required premium.

If Proof of Insurability is required, You will not be covered unless You satisfy the Proof of Insurability requirements stated in the Certificate and Schedule of Benefits.

B400.0047

Limitation of Authority

Only the President, a Vice President or a Secretary of Guardian, has the authority to act for Us in a written and signed statement to:

- Determine whether any contract, Policy or certificate is to be issued;
- Waive or alter any contract or Policy provisions, or any of Our requirements;
- Bind Us by any statement or promise relating to the contract issued or to be issued; or
- Accept any information or representation which is not in a signed application.

Agents and brokers do not have the authority to change the contract or Policy or waive any of its provisions.

B400.0049

Incontestability

This Certificate is incontestable after two years from its date of issue, except for non-payment of premiums.

No statement in any application, except a fraudulent statement, made by You will be used to contest the validity of Your insurance or to deny a claim for a loss incurred, or for a disability which starts, after such insurance has been in force for two years during Your lifetime.

No statement made by any person insured under the policy relating to his or her insurability or his or her insured dependents shall be used in contesting the validity of the insurance with respect to which such statement was made:

- After the insurance has been in force, prior to the contest, for a period of two years during the lifetime of the person about whom the statement was made; and
- Unless the statement is contained in a written instrument signed by him or her.

If this Certificate replaces a plan Your Employer had with another insurer, We may rescind this Certificate based on misrepresentations or omissions made by the Employer or You in a signed application for up to two years from the Effective Date of the Policy.

In the event Your insurance is rescinded, We will refund premiums paid for the periods such insurance is void. The premium paid by You will be sent to Your last known address on file with Your Employer or Us.

B400.7759

Examination

We have the right to have a Doctor(s) of Our choice examine the person for whom a claim is being made under this Certificate as often as We feel reasonably necessary. We will pay for all such examinations.

B400.7761

ELIGIBILITY FOR SHORT TERM DISABILITY INCOME COVERAGE

Conditions of Eligibility

You are eligible for Short Term Disability if You are:

- In an eligible class of Employees;
- Are an active Full-Time (17.5 hours or more) Employee;
- Legally working in the United States and/or Canada or working outside of the United States for a United States based Employer in a country or region approved by Us; and
- Working at least the minimum required number of hours of an Employee in Your eligible class at:
 - The Employer's place of business;
 - Some place where the Employer's business requires You to travel; or
 - Any other place You and the Employer have agreed upon for the performance of the major duties of Your job.

B400.7763

You are **not** eligible for Short Term Disability if You are:

- A temporary or seasonal Employee; or
- Earning less than \$10,000.00 per year.

B400.0055

Enrollment Requirement: If You must pay all or part of the cost of Your coverage, We will not cover You until You enroll and agree to make the required payments.

B400.0059

Proof of Insurability: Part or all of Your insurance amounts may be subject to Proof of Insurability. The Schedule Of Benefits explains if and when We require proof. You will not be covered for any amount that requires such proof until You give the proof to Us and We approve that proof in writing.

B400.0060

The Waiting Period: If You are in an eligible class, You are eligible for Short Term Disability under this Certificate after you complete the service waiting period, if any, established by the Employer.

B400.0061

Multiple Employment: If You work for both the Employer and a covered associated company, or for more than one covered associated company, We will treat You as if only one firm employs You. You will not have multiple Short Term Disability coverage under this Certificate. But, if this Certificate uses the amount of Your Insured Earnings to set the rates, determine class, figure coverage amounts, or for any other reason, such earnings will be figured as the sum of Your Insured Earnings from all covered Employers.

B400.0062

When Coverage Starts

For coverage to start, You must be fully capable of performing the major duties of Your Own Job for the Employer working the minimum required number of hours of an Employee in Your eligible class at 12:01 A.M. Standard Time for Your place of residence on Your scheduled Eligibility Date. And, for coverage to start, You must meet all of the Conditions of Eligibility described above and the conditions shown below which apply to You. If You are not fully capable of performing the major duties of Your Own Job on Your scheduled Eligibility Date, We will postpone the start of Your coverage while this Certificate is in force. We will postpone coverage until You are so capable and working the minimum required number of hours of an Employee in Your eligible class for one full day, with the capacity to do so for one full week.

Whether You must pay all or part of the cost of Your coverage, You must elect to enroll and agree to make the required payments before Your coverage will start. If You do this on or before Your Eligibility Date, Your coverage is scheduled to start on Your Eligibility Date. If You do this within 31 days after Your Eligibility Date, Your coverage is scheduled to start on the date You sign Your enrollment form. If You elect to enroll and agree to make the required payments more than 31 days after Your Eligibility Date, Your coverage will not start until You send Us Proof of Insurability. Once We have approved such proof, Your coverage is scheduled to start on Your approved Eligibility Date.

B400.0064

Exception to When Coverage Starts

Sometimes a scheduled Eligibility Date is not a regularly scheduled work day. If the scheduled Eligibility Date falls on:

- A holiday;
- A vacation day;
- A non-scheduled work day;

- A day during an approved leave of absence not due to Sickness or Injury, of 90 days or less; or
- A day during a period of absence that is less than 7 days in duration;

and if:

- You were fully capable of performing the major duties of Your Own Job for the Employer for the minimum number of hours of an Employee in Your eligible class at 12:01 AM Standard Time for Your place of residence on the scheduled Eligibility Date; and
- You were performing the major duties of Your Own Job and working the minimum number of hours of an Employee in Your eligible class on Your last regularly scheduled work day.

Your coverage will start on the scheduled Eligibility Date. However, any coverage or part of coverage for which You must elect and pay all or part of the cost, will not start if You are on an approved leave and such coverage or part of coverage was not previously in force for You under a prior plan which this Certificate replaced.

Any part of Your coverage which is subject to Proof of Insurability will not start unless You send such proof to Us, and We approve it in writing. Once We have approved it, that part of Your coverage is scheduled to start on Your approved Eligibility Date.

B400.0066

Delayed Effective Date For Short Term Disability Income Coverage: If, due to Sickness or Injury, You are not Actively At Work and working the minimum required number of hours of an Employee in Your eligible class, on Your scheduled Eligibility Date for Short Term Disability, We will postpone coverage for any condition(s) that prevent you from meeting the Active Work requirement. We will postpone such coverage until You complete one full day of Active Work working Your regular number of hours, with the capacity to do so for one full week, and without missing a work day due to the same condition(s). Coverage for an otherwise covered loss due to all other conditions will start on the date You return to Active Work working the minimum required number of hours of Your eligible class and performing the regular duties of Your job.

B400.0067

Transfer Business Exception: If You are not Actively at Work and not working the minimum required number of hours of an Employee in Your eligible class, due to Sickness or Injury, on Your Scheduled Eligibility Date, You will be insured for Short Term Disability insurance if:

- You were insured under the prior insurer's group Short Term Disability policy with this Employer at the time the prior insurer's group Short Term Disability policy ended and the group Short Term Disability Policy became effective with Us, with no break in group coverage;
- You were a member of an eligible class under the prior carrier's group Short Term Disability policy and are eligible under this Certificate;
- Premiums for You were paid up to date for the prior carrier's group Short Term Disability policy and this Certificate; and

- You are not receiving or eligible to receive benefits under the prior insurer's group Short Term Disability policy.

If you continue to be incapable of performing the major duties of Your Own Job for the Employer and subsequently become Disabled, any Disability benefit payable will be the lesser of:

- The Short Term Disability benefit payable under this Certificate; or
- The Short Term Disability benefit payable under the prior insurer's group Short Term Disability policy had it remained in force.

B400.0095

When Coverage Ends

Your coverage will end on the first of the following dates:

- The date Your Active Work ends for any reason, except as shown below under Continuation Of Coverage.
- The date You stop being an eligible Employee under this Certificate.
- The date You are no longer working in the United States and/or Canada, or no longer working outside of the United States for a United States based employer in a country or region approved by Us. Any incidental business or personal travel outside of the United States and/or Canada, or outside of a country or region approved by Us, is covered. Such travel will be considered incidental if it is for a period not to exceed 30 consecutive days.
- The date the group Certificate ends, or is discontinued for a class of Employees to which You belong.
- The last day of the period for which required payments are made for You.
- The date You die.

You may have the right to continue certain group benefits for a limited time after Your coverage would otherwise end. Read this Certificate carefully for details and discuss with your Employer or administrator. Any provisions that allow continuation of such group benefits must be offered and administered on a fair and equitable basis.

B400.7767

CONTINUATION OF COVERAGE

Coverage During Disability

You may be Disabled when Your Active Work ends due to a non-job related Injury or Sickness for which benefits are not payable. In that case, Your coverage will remain in force during the:

- Elimination Period, subject to payment of required premiums; and
- The period of time for which benefits are payable by this Certificate.

But, in order for Your coverage to continue, the Disability:

- Must be covered by this Certificate.

If You're Disabled when Your Active Full-Time Work ends due to a job-related Injury or Sickness for which benefits are not payable, Your coverage will remain in force until the earlier of the date:

- You are terminated from employment with the Employer; or
- You have been Disabled for 6 Months.

B440.0070

SHORT TERM DISABILITY INCOME COVERAGE

This coverage replaces part of Your income if You become Disabled due to a covered Sickness or Injury. What We pay is governed by all the terms of this Policy. This Certificate includes the Short Term Disability Schedule of Benefits. Your class and benefit options are shown in the Schedule of Benefits that applies to You.

Terms with special meanings are defined, and are capitalized. See the Definitions section of this Certificate. Other terms with special meanings are defined where they are used.

Benefit Provisions

How Payments Start: To start getting payments from this Certificate, You must meet all of the conditions listed below and elsewhere in this Certificate.

- You must:
 - Become Disabled while covered by this Certificate; and
 - Remain Disabled and covered for this Certificate's Elimination Period.
- You must provide Proof of Loss, as described in Claim Provisions.

Benefits accrue as of the first day after the end of the Elimination Period, subject to all Certificate terms.

You can satisfy the Elimination Period while working, provided You are Disabled.

Waiver Of Premium: We waive Your premiums for this coverage while You are entitled to receive a Weekly Benefit payment from this Certificate.

When Payments End: Your benefits from this Certificate will end on the earliest of the dates shown below:

- The date You are no longer Disabled.
- The date You fail to provide Proof of Loss as required by this Certificate.
- The date You earn, or are able to earn, the maximum earnings allowed while Disabled under this Certificate.
- The date You are able to perform the major duties of Your Own Job on a Full-Time basis with Reasonable Accommodation.
- The date You die.
- The end of the Maximum Payment Period.
- The date no further benefits are payable under any provision in this Certificate that limits the Maximum Payment Period.
- The date You are no longer receiving Regular and Appropriate Care from a Doctor.

- The date payments end in accordance with a Rehabilitation Agreement.

B400.7777

Maximum Payment Period: The Maximum Payment Period is shown in the Schedule Of Benefits. But, it may be less than that shown due to:

- The date You were first treated for the cause of Your Disability; and
- The length of time You have been covered by this Certificate. See Pre-Existing Conditions.

Benefits payable during the Maximum Payment Period will not be affected by the termination of the Certificate, subject to all the terms and conditions of the Certificate that were in effect on the first date of Your Disability. Any change to the Certificate with an Effective Date after the first date of Your Disability will not apply to benefits payable during the Maximum Payment Period.

B400.0144

Recurring Disability: Benefits from this Certificate end if You cease to be Disabled. But, a later Disability may be treated as a Recurring Disability, if all of the conditions listed below are met:

- You must return to Active Work right after Your benefits end.
- The Disability must recur less than two weeks after You were last entitled to benefits.
- The later Disability must be due to the same or related cause of Your earlier Disability.
- This Certificate must not end during Your return to Active Work.
- You must not become covered under any other similar group income replacement plan during the time You return to Active Work.
- When You return to Active Work after being disabled, You must be covered by this Certificate and all required premium must be paid.
- A subsequent Disability will not be considered a Recurring Disability if Your benefits for the prior Disability ended because Your prior Disability had been paid for the Maximum Payment Period.

If the later Disability is a Recurring Disability, You will not need to satisfy a new Elimination Period. The Recurring Disability will be subject to all the terms of this Certificate in effect on the date the earlier Disability began.

If all of the conditions listed above are not met, the later Disability will be treated as a new period of Disability. You will be required to satisfy a new Elimination Period. The new period of Disability will be subject to all the terms of this Certificate in effect on the date the new period of Disability starts.

B400.0146

Calculation of Weekly Benefit: Your benefit is governed by the terms of this Certificate in effect on the date Disability starts. Any changes to this Certificate that take place as follows are inapplicable to, and will not affect, Your benefit:

- While You are Disabled; or
- During a period of Active Work that occurs between an initial period of Disability and a Recurring Disability.

We calculate Your Gross Weekly Benefit according to the Schedule of Benefits. This Certificate includes Proof of Insurability requirements that may affect the amount of Your Gross Weekly Benefit. The Schedule of Benefits explains these requirements

B400.0149

Redetermination: This Certificate redetermines Your Insured Earnings on each January 1st, the Employer must report current Insured Earnings for all Employees under this Certificate. Changes to Your Insured Earnings are subject to any Proof of Insurability requirements that may apply to this Certificate. As of this Certificate's redetermination date, We use Your Insured Earnings on record with Us to:

- Set rates;
- Project benefit amounts and limits; and
- Calculate premium payable under this Certificate.

You must be Actively at Work on that date. If You are not, We do not do this until the date You return to Active Work. But, changes in earnings will not apply to a Recurring Disability.

B400.7798

Adjustment Of Weekly Benefit For Disability Earnings: We adjust the Weekly Benefit for Disability Earnings as follows:

We pay the greater of the amount calculated under Method 1 or Method 2.

Method 1:

- If your Disability Earnings are less than 20% of Your Insured Earnings, We do not reduce your Weekly Benefit.
- If your Disability Earnings are 20% or more of Your Insured Earnings, We reduce Your Weekly Benefit by 50% of Your Disability Earnings.

Method 2:

- (1) Subtract Your Disability Earnings from Your Insured Earnings.
- (2) Divide the result in (1) above by Your Insured Earnings.
- (3) Multiply the result in (2) above by Your Weekly Benefit. This is the amount We pay.

If Your Disability Earnings fluctuate widely from week to week, We may adjust Your Weekly Benefit using an average Disability Earnings amount. The average Disability Earnings amount will be computed using Your most current week's Disability Earnings and the prior two weeks Disability Earnings.

B400.0199

Maximum Allowable Disability Earnings: This Certificate limits the amount of income You may earn, or may be able to earn, and still be considered Disabled.

If Your Disability Earnings are more than 80% of Your Insured Earnings, payments from this Certificate will end. Payments from this Certificate will also end if You are able to earn more than 80% of Your Insured Earnings.

B400.0200

Minimum Payment: The minimum weekly payment for Disability under this Certificate is \$25.00.

B400.0201

Limitation and Exclusions

Pre-Existing Conditions: A pre-existing condition is an Injury or Sickness, whether diagnosed or misdiagnosed, and any symptoms of it, for which, in the "look back period", You:

- Receive advice or treatment from a Doctor;
- Underwent diagnostic procedures other than routine screening in the absence of symptoms or suspicion of disease process by a Doctor;
- Were prescribed or took prescription drugs; or
- Receive other medical care or treatment, including consultation with a Doctor.

The "look back period" is the 3 Months before the latest of:

- Your Eligibility Date for coverage under this Certificate;
- The Effective Date of a change that increases the benefits payable by this Certificate; and
- The Eligibility Date of a change in Your benefit election that increases the benefit payable by this Certificate.

No benefits are payable for Disability caused by, contributed to, by, or resulting from a pre-existing condition; unless the Disability starts after You complete at least one full day of Active Work after the date You have been covered under this Certificate for 12 months in a row.

Your Disability caused by, contributed to, by, or resulting from a Pre- Existing Condition may begin after:

- A change which provides for an increase in the benefits payable by this Certificate; or
- A change in Your benefit election which increases the benefit payable by this Certificate.

In this case, Your benefit will be limited to the amount that would have been payable had the change not taken place. But, this limit does not apply if Your Disability starts after You complete at least one full day of Active Work after the date the change has been in force for 12 Months in a row.

We do not cover any Disability that starts before Your coverage under this Certificate.

B400.0204

Prior Coverage Credit: If this Certificate replaces a similar Disability income replacement plan the Employer had with another insurer, the Pre-Existing Condition provision may not apply to You, if coverage under this Certificate starts immediately after the termination of coverage under the prior Disability income replacement plan.

This Certificate must start right after the prior plan ends.

The Pre-Existing Condition provision will be waived for You if You:

- Are Actively Working on Your Eligibility Date for coverage under this Certificate; and
- Have fulfilled the requirements of any Pre-Existing Condition provision of the prior plan provided by the Employer.

You may have been covered under the prior plan when it ended, but have not met the requirements of any Pre-Existing Condition provision of the prior plan. In that case, We credit any time used to meet the prior plan's Pre-Existing Condition provision toward meeting this Certificate's Pre-Existing Condition provision. You must:

- Enroll for coverage under this Certificate on or before this Certificate's Effective Date; and
- Be Actively Working on Your Eligibility Date for coverage under this Certificate.

But, We limit Your maximum Weekly Benefit under this Certificate if:

- It is more than the maximum Weekly Benefit for which You were covered under the prior plan provided by the Employer;
- You become Disabled due to a Pre-Existing Condition; and
- This Certificate pays benefits for such Disability because We credit time as explained above.

In this case, We limit the maximum Weekly Benefit to the amount to which You would have been entitled under the prior plan.

We deduct all payments made by the prior plan under an extension provision.

B400.0207

Exclusions

This Certificate does not pay benefits for Disability caused by, or related to:

- Declared or undeclared war, act of war, or armed aggression;
- Service in the armed forces, National Guard, or military reserves of any state or country;

- Your taking part in a riot or civil disorder;
- Your commission of, or attempt to commit, a felony. A felony means either:
 - A crime as defined as such under the laws in the jurisdiction in which the crime was committed or attempted; or
 - In states where the law does not define crimes in terms of felonies and misdemeanors, felony means any crime punishable for a minimum of a one year term of incarceration in a jail or prison, as determined by the law of the jurisdiction where the crime was committed or attempted; or
 - A crime as defined as such under federal law;
- An Injury that occurs while, or a Sickness that develops from, performing an occupational duty except for those Employees who are not eligible to participate in Workers' Compensation, occupational disease law, or any other law of like intent; or for an Injury that occurs while, or a Sickness that develops from, performing an occupational duty while working for another employer.

This Certificate does not pay any benefits for any period of Disability:

- During which You are confined to a facility as a result of Your conviction of a crime;
- During which You are receiving medical treatment or care outside the United States or Canada unless expressly authorized by Us;
- Which starts before You are covered by this Certificate;
- After the date You have been outside the United States and/or Canada or a country or region approved by Us for more than 2 Months in a 12 Month period. If You return to the United States and/or Canada or a country or region approved by Us within 6 Months of the end of payments, payments may be resumed, provided You have remained continuously Disabled, subject to all the terms and conditions of this Certificate; or
- During which Your loss of earnings is not solely due to Your Disability.

This Certificate does not pay benefits due solely to a risk of relapse or exacerbation of a prior Injury or illness in the absence of current impairment and Disability.

B400.7802

Services

Rehabilitation And Case Management: We will review Your Disability to see if certain services are likely to help You return to Gainful Work. If needed, We may ask for more medical or vocational information.

When Our review is complete, We may offer You a Rehabilitation Program.

The Rehabilitation Program will start when a written Rehabilitation Agreement is signed by:

- You;
- Us; and
- Your Employer, if needed.

The program may include, but is not limited to:

- Vocational assessment of Your work potential;
- Coordination and transition planning with an Employer for Your return to work;
- Consulting with Your Doctor on Your return to work and need for accommodations;
- Training in job seeking skills and resume preparation; and
- Retraining.

We have the right to determine which services are appropriate.

If You accept the Rehabilitation Agreement, We will pay an enhanced benefit. The enhanced benefit will be 110% of the Weekly Benefit that would otherwise be paid. This enhanced benefit will be payable as of the first Weekly Benefit after the Rehabilitation Program starts.

We stop paying the enhanced benefit on the earliest of:

- The date Your benefits from this Certificate end;
- The date You violate the terms of the Rehabilitation Agreement;
- The date You end the Rehabilitation Program; or
- The date the Rehabilitation Agreement ends.

If You end a Rehabilitation Program without Our consent, You must repay any enhanced benefits paid.

Dependent Care Expenses: While You are participating in a Rehabilitation Program, We will pay a dependent care expense benefit, when all of the following conditions are met:

- You incur expense to provide care for a qualified dependent; and
- The care is provided by a licensed provider other than a family member by blood or marriage.

The dependent care expense benefit will be the lesser of:

- \$100.00 per week per qualified dependent; not to exceed \$300.00 per week for all qualified dependents combined; and
- The actual weekly day care expense incurred by You.

We will stop paying the dependent care expense benefit on the earlier of the date You are no longer:

- Incurring dependent care expenses for a qualified dependent;

- Participating in a Rehabilitation Program; or
- Entitled to receive a Weekly Benefit from this Certificate.

As used here, "qualified dependent" means a person who is:

- Dependent upon You for main support and maintenance; and
- Under the age of 14; and
- Your biological child, lawfully adopted child, stepchild or any other child who is living with You in a regular parent-child relationship.

The term also means a family member, related by blood or marriage, age 14 or over who is physically or mentally incapable of caring for him or herself and is dependent upon You for main support and maintenance.

B400.7804

Worksite Modification: In order to accommodate Your Disability, an Employer may incur a cost to modify his or her worksite. We may reimburse the Employer, up to \$2,500.00 for the cost of the worksite modification. We make this payment if We agree that the modification will enable You to:

- Return to work; or
- Remain at work.

B400.0212

Claim Provisions

Authority: We have the authority to:

- Interpret the terms of this Certificate; and
- Determine Your eligibility for coverage and benefits under this Certificate.

All such determinations are conclusive and binding, except that they may be modified or reversed by a court or regulatory agency with appropriate jurisdiction.

Notice: You or Your Administrator must send Us written notice of Your intent to file a claim under this Certificate within 20 days of the date the Injury occurs or the Sickness starts. This notice should include Your name and the Policy number. For details, You can call Us at 1-800-268-2525.

Proof Of Loss: When We receive Your Notice, We will provide You with a claim form within 15 days for filing Proof of Loss. This form requires data from the Employer, You, and the Doctor(s) treating Your Sickness or Injury. Proof of Loss must be given to Us within 90 days of the loss. If You do not receive a claim form within 15 days of the date You sent Your Notice, You should send Us written Proof of Loss without waiting for the form. We will not void or reduce Your claim if You cannot send Us Notice of claim and Proof of Loss within the required time. In that case, You must send Us Notice of claim and Proof of Loss as soon as reasonably possible.

You are required to cooperate with Guardian in its evaluation of any claim for benefits. You must provide Proof of Loss at Your expense, consisting of the following listed below. Failure to provide this information may prevent, delay, suspend, reduce or terminate Your eligibility for benefits.

- The date Disability began.
- Your last day of Active Work.
- The cause of Disability.
- The extent of Disability, including limitations and restrictions preventing You from performing the major duties of Your Own Job.
- If Your occupation requires that You carry liability or malpractice insurance, information including, but not limited to: the policy, any applications for such coverage, and any changes to the terms and conditions of such policies prior to or after the first date of Disability.
- Objective Medical Evidence in support of Your limitations and restrictions, beginning with the date Disability began.
- Objective Proof of Your Restrictions and Limitations, beginning with the date Disability began.
- The prognosis of Disability.

- The name and address of all Doctors, hospitals and health care facilities where You have been treated for Your Disability since the date Disability began.
- Proof that You are currently receiving Regular and Appropriate Care from a Doctor.
- Proof that You have been receiving Regular and Appropriate Care from a Doctor, from the date Disability began.
- Proof of Insured Earnings.
- Proof of Disability Earnings.
- Payroll or absence data from the Employer for the three months prior to the date Disability began, or other period We specify.
- Proof of application for all other sources of income to which You may be entitled, that may affect Your payment from this Certificate.
- Proof of receipt of other income that may affect Your payment from this Certificate.
- Proof of identity and residency, including, but not limited to, a current government issued photo identification.
- Documentation of travel outside the United States.
- Any other information We may reasonably require to determine if You are Disabled and eligible for benefits and coverage under this Certificate.

You must provide Objective Medical Evidence from a Doctor who is not Yourself, or a relative by blood or marriage, or who is a business associate.

Proof of Insured Earnings and Disability Earnings may consist of:

- Copies of Your W-2 forms;
- Payroll records from Your Employer(s);
- Copies of Your U.S. individual income tax returns;
- Copies of the U.S. income tax returns from any business in which You hold an ownership or shareholder interest;
- A statement from a certified public accountant;
- Copies of any income records accepted or required by the IRS; or
- Any other records We deem necessary.

Proof of loss and other claim data should be submitted to:

The Guardian Life Insurance Company of America
 Group Short Term Disability Claims Department
 P.O. Box 14331
 Lexington, KY 40512.

Authorization Required: You must provide Us with written, unaltered authorizations in a form provided by Us to obtain medical, financial, vocational, occupational, and governmental information required to determine Our liability under this Certificate. We may agree to obtain such authorization by use of voice or other electronic means. You must provide Us with such authorizations as often as We may require, in order that they remain current. Failure to provide such authorizations may prevent, delay, suspend or terminate Your eligibility for benefits.

Right To Request Medical, Financial Or Vocational Assessment: We may ask You to take part in a medical, financial, vocational or other assessment that We feel is necessary to determine whether the terms of this Certificate are met.

Medical assessment may include, but not be limited to:

- Independent medical examination (IMEs),
- Functional capacity examinations (FCEs) or
- Neuropsychological evaluations.

We may require medical, financial or vocational assessment(s) as often as We feel is reasonably necessary. We will pay for all such assessments. But, if You postpone a scheduled assessment without Our approval, You will be responsible for any rescheduling fees. If You do not take part in or cooperate with the assessment, We have the right to stop or suspend Your payments under this Certificate.

Ongoing Proof Of Loss: To continue to receive payments from this Certificate, You must give Us current Proof of Loss as often as We may reasonably require. Ongoing Proof of Loss must be provided to Us within 30 days of the date We request it.

Payment Of Benefits: We pay benefits to You, if You are legally competent. If You are not, We pay benefits to your lawful guardian, conservator, legal representative, or any person or fiduciary with the lawful authority to act on Your behalf or handle Your affairs. Benefits are paid in United States currency.

We pay benefits biweekly at the end of the period for which they are payable.

No benefits are payable for this Certificate's Elimination Period.

Benefits to which You are entitled may remain unpaid at Your death. Such benefits may be paid to:

- Your estate; or
- Your Spouse, parents, children, or brothers and sisters.

Partial Week Payment: You may be Disabled for only part of a week. In this case, We compute Your payment as 1/7th of the benefit to which You would be entitled for the full week times the number of days You are Disabled.

Overpayment Recovery: If We overpaid You, You must repay Us in full. We have the right to reduce Your payment or apply any benefits payable, including the minimum payment, toward recovery of the overpayment.

Legal Actions: No legal action against Guardian related to claim for benefits under this Certificate may be brought until 60 days from the date Proof of Loss has been given as shown above. No legal action may be brought against Guardian related to claims for benefits under this Certificate after three years from the date of the final benefit determination.

Workers' Compensation: The Short Term Disability benefits provided by this Certificate are not in place of and do not affect requirements for coverage by Workers' Compensation.

B400.7805

SUBROGATION AND RIGHT OF RECOVERY

Purpose: When You have the right to recover amounts paid by this Certificate, We also have certain rights. These are explained below.

Subrogation: When this Certificate pays a benefit, We will immediately be subrogated to Your rights of recovery from any third party to the full extent of benefits paid.

Recovery: If You receive a payment from any third party or insurance coverage due to an Injury, Sickness or condition, We have the right to recover from, and be repaid by, You for all amounts this Certificate has paid due to that Injury, Sickness or condition, up to and including the full amount You receive from any third party or insurance coverage.

Constructive Trust: You must serve as a constructive trustee over the funds that constitute payment from any third party or insurance coverage due to Your Injury, Sickness or condition. If You fail to hold such funds in trust, it will be deemed a breach of Your fiduciary duty to Us.

Lien Rights: We will have a lien to the extent of benefits We paid due to Your Injury, Sickness or condition for which the third party is liable. The lien will be imposed on any recovery, whether by settlement, judgment, or otherwise, including from any insurance coverage, that You receive due to Your Injury, Sickness or condition. The lien may be enforced against any party who holds funds or proceeds which represent the amount of benefits paid by Us. This includes, but is not limited to:

- You;
- Your representative or agent;
- The third party;
- The third party's insurer, representative or agent; and
- Any other source who holds such funds.

First Priority Claim: This Certificate's recovery rights are a first priority claim against all third parties and are to be paid to Us before any other claim for Your damages. This Certificate will be entitled to full repayment on a first dollar basis from any third party's payments, even if such payment to the plan will result in a recovery to You which is not sufficient:

- To make You whole; or
- To compensate You in part or in whole for the damages sustained.

This Certificate is not required to participate in or pay court costs or attorney fees to the attorney hired by You to pursue Your damage claim.

Applicable To All Settlements And Judgments: We are entitled to full recovery regardless of whether:

- Any liability for payment is admitted by a third party; or

- The settlement or judgment received by You identifies the benefits the plan paid.

This Certificate is entitled to recover from any and all settlements or judgments, even those designated as pain and suffering or non-economic damages only.

Cooperation: You must fully cooperate with Our efforts to recover the benefits paid under this Certificate. You must notify Us within 30 days of the date when any notice is given to any party, including an insurance company or attorney, of Your intention to pursue or investigate a claim to recover damages or obtain compensation due to Injury, Sickness or condition sustained by You. You and Your agents, must provide all information requested by Us or Our representative. This includes, but is not limited to, completing and submitting any applications or other forms or statements as We may reasonably request. Failure to do this may result in the termination of benefits or the instigation of legal action against You.

You must do nothing:

- To prejudice Our rights as described in this section; or
- To prejudice Our ability to enforce the terms of this section.

This includes, but is not limited to, refraining from making any settlement or recovery that attempts to reduce or exclude the full amount of all benefits paid by this Certificate.

We have the right to conduct an investigation regarding the Injury, Sickness or condition to identify any third party. We reserve the right to notify the third party and his or her agents of Our lien. Agents include, but are not limited to:

- Insurance companies; and
- Attorneys.

Interpretation: In the event that any claim is made that any part of this section is ambiguous, or questions arise as to the meaning or intent of any of its terms, We have the authority to resolve all disputes regarding the interpretation of this section.

Jurisdiction: Any legal action or proceeding with respect to this section may be brought in any court of competent jurisdiction as We may choose. You must submit to each such jurisdiction and waive whatever rights may correspond to You by reason of Your present or future domicile.

Definitions: As used in this section, the terms listed below have the meanings shown below:

- **Legal Guardian:** This term means a person who has the care or the legal or fiduciary responsibility to manage the affairs or property of another.
- **Insurance Coverage:** This term means any insurance which provides coverage for:
 - Medical expense payments; or
 - Liability.

This includes, but is not limited to:

- Uninsured motorist coverage;
 - Underinsured motorist coverage;
 - Personal umbrella coverage;
 - Medical payments coverage;
 - Workers compensation coverage;
 - No-fault automobile insurance coverage; or
 - Any first party insurance.
- **Third Party:** This term means any party actually, possibly, or potentially responsible for making any payment to You due to Your Injury, Sickness or condition. This term also means such party's:
 - Liability insurer; or
 - Any insurance coverage.

But, this term does not mean:

- Us; or
 - You.
- **You:** This term means the covered Employee. It also includes Your parent or Legal Guardian if You are a minor or incompetent.

B400.7807

DEFINITIONS

Active Work, Actively At Work or Actively Working: These terms mean You are able to perform, and are performing, all of the regular duties of Your work for the Employer, at:

- One of the Employer's usual places of business;
- Some place where the Employer's business requires You to travel; or
- Any other place You and the Employer have agreed on for Your work.

B400.7809

Certificate: This term means this Certificate of Coverage, including the Schedule of Benefits and any riders and enrollment forms that may be attached to this Certificate.

B400.0336

Disability or Disabled: These terms mean that a current Sickness or Injury causes impairment to such a degree that You are:

- Not able to perform the major duties of Your Own Job; and
- Not able to earn more than this Plan's maximum allowed Disability Earnings.

If, prior to your Disability, You are required to work more than 40 hours per week, on average, You will not be considered Disabled if You can work for 40 hours per week.

Neither loss of a professional or occupational license due to misconduct or unlawful activity, nor receipt of, or entitlement to, Social Security Disability benefits in and of themselves constitute Disability under this Certificate.

B400.7826

Disability Earnings: This term means the weekly income You earn from Working While Disabled. It includes salaries, wages, commissions, bonuses and any other compensation earned or accrued while working including pension, profit sharing contributions, sick pay, paid time off, holiday and vacation pay. When You have an ownership interest in the business, Disability Earnings also includes business profits, attributable to You, whether received or not. It includes any income You earn while Disabled and return to the Employer, partnership, or any other similar business arrangement to cover any business or overhead expenses. If You have the ability to work on a Part-Time or Full-Time basis, Disability earnings also includes Maximum Capacity Earnings beginning with the earlier of the date You have been:

- Terminated from employment with the Employer;
- Disabled for four weeks in a row; or
- Offered a job or workplace modification by the Employer and You do not return to work.

You may have held a job with an employer other than Your Employer, immediately prior to the start of Your Disability. While benefits are payable while Working While Disabled, Disability Earnings will not include earnings from a job with an employer other than Your Employer, if such job was held immediately prior to the start of Your Disability. If Working While Disabled and the income from the job with the other employer exceeds Your average amount of earnings for that other employer for the six months immediately prior to the start of Your Disability, We will include such excess as Disability Earnings.

B400.0234

Doctor: Any medical practitioner We are required by law to recognize. He or she must:

- Be properly licensed or certified by the laws of the state where he or she practices; and
- Provide services that are within the lawful scope of his or her practice.

B400.0235

Effective Date: The date the Policy goes into force and effect as stated on the cover page of the Certificate of Coverage, or any change to the Policy as requested by the Policyholder and approved by Us and in force and effect as stated on cover page of the Certificate of Coverage.

B400.0236

Eligibility Date: This term means the earliest date You are eligible for coverage under this Certificate, and you have satisfied all requirements for coverage to begin, as required by this Certificate.

- For an Employee in Active Work who has completed any waiting period required by the Employer as of the Effective Date of this Certificate, the Eligibility Date will be the Effective Date of this Certificate.
- For an Employee in Active Work as of the Effective Date of this Certificate who has not completed any waiting period required by the Employer, the Eligibility Date will be the first date following the completion of the required waiting period.
- For an Employee hired on or after the Effective Date of this Certificate, the Eligibility Date will be the later of the Employee's date of hire, or the first date following the completion of any waiting period required by the Employer.
- If this Certificate requires Employees to elect coverage under this Certificate, the Eligibility Date will be the later of:
 - The Employee's date of hire;
 - The first date following the completion of any waiting period required by the Employer; or
 - The date We approve in writing Your application for any coverage for which You are required to supply Proof of Insurability.

B400.0238

Elimination Period: This term means the period of time, as shown in the Schedule of Benefits, You must be Disabled, due to a covered Disability, before this Certificate's benefits are payable.

Any days during which You return to work earning more than 80% of Your Insured Earnings will not count toward the Elimination Period, but You will continue to accumulate days of Disability for days for which You return to work earning less than 80% during the Elimination Period as long You meet the definition of Disability each Week during the Elimination Period. If You are or become eligible under any other similar group income replacement plan while You are working during the Elimination Period, You will not be entitled to benefits from this Certificate.

We do not require You to complete an Elimination Period if:

- You were covered under a similar income replacement plan the Employer had with another carrier on the day before this Certificate starts; and
- Your Disability would have been a Recurring Disability under the prior plan had it remained in effect.

B400.0239

Employee: This term means a person who works for the Employer at the Employer's place of business and whose income is reported to the United States Internal Revenue Service, and/or a state for tax purposes. Partners and proprietors will also be treated as Employees if the Conditions of Eligibility requirements are met.

B400.0241

Employer: This term means a member employer as defined in the bylaws of the AMERICAN EMPLOYERS ALLIANCE.

B400.0243-R

Full-Time: This term means:

You regularly work at least 17.5 hours per week at:

- (1) Your Employer's place of business;
- (2) some place where the Employer's business requires You to travel; or
- (3) any other place You and Your Employer have agreed upon for the performance of occupational duties.

B400.7817

Gainful Occupation or Gainful Work: These terms mean work for which You are, or may become, qualified by:

- Training;
- Education; or
- Experience.

When You are able to perform such work, You can be expected to earn at least 80% of Your Insured Earnings, within 12 months of returning to work.

B400.0245

Government Plan: This term means any of the following:

- The United States Social Security Act;
- The Railroad Retirement Act;
- The Canadian Pension Plan;
- Medicaid; or
- Any other plan provided under the laws of a state, province or any other political subdivision.

It also includes:

- Any public employee Retirement Plan; or
- Any plan provided in place of the above named plan or acts.

It does not include:

- Any Workers' Compensation Act or similar law;
- The Jones' Act;
- The Longshoreman's and Harbor Workers' Compensation Act; or
- The Maritime Doctrine of Maintenance, Wages, or Cure.

B400.7818

Gross Weekly Benefit: This term means this Certificate's Weekly Benefit before it is integrated with other income and earnings.

B400.0247

Injury: This term means a bodily Injury due to an accident that occurs while You are covered by this Certificate. Subject to all other requirements, We will cover a Disability caused by an Injury when the Disability starts within 90 days of the date of such Injury.

B400.0248

Insured Earnings: Only Your earnings from the Employer will be included as Insured Earnings.

Your Gross Weekly Benefit may be limited due to Proof of Insurability requirements. In this case, only the part of Your Insured Earnings that applies to the amount of Your limited Gross Weekly Benefit is used to calculate premiums due under this Certificate. We calculate benefit amounts and limits based on the amount of Your Insured Earnings as of the Redetermination date immediately prior to the start of Your Disability. See the Redetermination and Proof of Insurability sections of this Certificate.

B400.0249

- **For Partners And S Corporation Shareholders:** Insured Earnings means the sum of the amounts listed below, divided by 52.

- Your compensation as an Employee or S Corporation shareholder, or guaranteed payments as a Partner, as reported on Your Federal Income Tax Return(s), Form 1040, for the prior calendar year, less the gross total of unadjusted Employee business expenses as included on the corresponding Schedule A-Itemized Deductions.
- Your non-passive income (loss) from trade of business as reported on Schedule E - Part II of Your Federal Income Tax Return(s), Form 1040, for the prior calendar year, less any expenses incurred and reported elsewhere on Your Return; and
- Your contributions during the prior calendar year, deposited into a:
 - Cash or deferred compensation plan, or salary reduction plan, qualified under IRC section 401(k), 403(b), 457 or similar plan; and
 - Elective Employee pre-tax deferrals to a Section 125 plan or flexible spending account.

You may not have been a partner or S Corporation shareholder for the full prior calendar year. In that case, Your earnings are based on the weekly average of the sum of the listed amounts averaged for the full number of weeks that You were a partner or S Corporation shareholder during that calendar year.

- **For Sole Proprietors:** Insured Earnings means the sum of the amounts listed below.
 - Your average weekly net profit as determined from Schedule C - Part II of Your Federal Income Tax Return(s), Form 1040 for the prior calendar year.
 - Your average weekly contribution during the prior calendar year deposited into a:
 - Cash or deferred compensation plan, or salary reduction plan, qualified under IRC section 401(k), 403(b), 457 or similar plan; and
 - Elective Employee pre-tax deferrals to a Section 125 plan or flexible spending account.

Weekly net profit is calculated as gross income less total expenses.

You may not have been a sole proprietor for the prior calendar year. In that case, We calculate average weekly net profit and average weekly contributions using the full number of weeks that You were a sole proprietor during such time.

- **For Any Other Employee Who Receives Base Salary Only:** Insured Earnings means Your base weekly salary from the Employer. Your base weekly salary will include shift differential.

The term also includes Your contributions deposited into a:

- Cash or deferred compensation plan, or salary reduction plan, qualified under IRC section 401(k), 403(b), 457 or similar plan; and
- Elective Employee pre-tax deferrals to a Section 125 plan or flexible spending account.

Earnings based on excluded income and Employer contributions deposited into such 401(k), 403(b), 457 or similar plan are not included.

The term also does not include:

- Bonuses;
- Commissions;
- Overtime pay;
- Expense accounts;
- Stock options; and
- Any other extra compensation.

If You are paid hourly, We calculate weekly earnings based on actual hours worked or billed in the eight weeks before the start of Your Disability. We do not include pay for hours worked or billed over 40 per week.

- **For Employees Who Are Compensated On Less Than A 12 Month Basis:** Insured Earnings means Your average rate of weekly earnings determined from Your annual contract salary. If You do not have an annual contract salary, Insured Earnings means Your prior calendar year salary divided by twelve. Your annual contract or prior calendar year salary will include shift differential.

The term also includes Your contributions deposited into a:

- Cash or deferred compensation plan, or salary reduction plan, qualified under IRC section 401(k), 403(b), 457 or similar plan; and
- Elective Employee pre-tax deferrals to a Section 125 plan or flexible spending account.

Earnings based on excluded income and Employer contributions deposited into such 401(k), 403(b), 457 or similar plan are not included.

The term also does not include:

- Overtime pay;
- Expense accounts;
- Stock options; and
- Any other extra compensation.

If You are paid hourly, We calculate weekly earnings based on actual hours worked or billed in the eight weeks before the start of Your Disability. We do not include pay for hours worked or billed over 40 per week.

- **For Employees Whose Income Is Reported On A IRS Form 1099:** Insured Earnings means Your average rate of weekly earnings as figured from the 1099 form(s) received from the Employer for the prior calendar year. Earnings are calculated as Your earned income as reported on the 1099 form(s) minus business expenses as reported on Schedule C - Part II of Your Federal Income Tax Return(s), Form 1040. Your average rate of weekly earnings is calculated as such earnings divided by 52 or the number of weeks You worked for the Employer during such calendar year, if less than 52.

The term also includes Your contributions deposited into a:

- Cash or deferred compensation plan, or salary reduction plan, qualified under IRC section 401(k), 403(b), 457 or similar plan; and
- Elective Employee pre-tax deferrals to a Section 125 plan or flexible spending account.

B400.0253

Maximum Capacity Earnings: This term means the income You could earn if working to the fullest extent to which You are able in Your Own Job. We decide the fullest extent of work You are able to do based on objective data provided by any or all of the following sources:

- Your treating Doctor;
- Impartial medical or vocational exams;
- Peer review specialists;
- Functional capacities exams; and
- Other medical and vocational specialists whose area of expertise is appropriate to Your Disability.

B400.0261

Maximum Payment Period: This term means the longest time that benefits are paid by this Certificate, subject to all terms, limitations and exclusions.

B400.0262

Month or Months or Monthly: These terms mean a consecutive 30 day period.

B400.0264

Objective Medical Evidence: This term includes, but is not Limited to:

- Diagnostic testing;
- Laboratory reports; and

- Medical records of a Doctor's exam documenting clinical signs, presence of symptoms and test results consistent with generally accepted medical standards supported by nationally recognized authorities in the health care field.

B400.0266

Objective Proof of Your Restrictions and Limitations: During the Own Job period this term means objective proof of Your inability to perform the duties of Your Own Job, and including all restrictions and limitations relating to Your inability to work.

B400.0267

Own Job: This term means Your job for the Employer. We use the job description provided by the Employer to determine the duties and requirements of Your Own Job.

B400.0268

Part-Time: This term means:

You regularly work less than 17.5 hours per week but not less than 12 hours per week at:

- (1) Your Employer's place of business;
- (2) some place where the Employer's business requires You to travel; or
- (3) any other place You and Your Employer have agreed upon for the performance of occupational duties.

B400.7819

Policy: This term means the group Short Term Disability income coverage described in the Policy and this Certificate.

B400.0272

Proof Of Insurability: This term means the completion of an evidence of insurability form which shows that a person is insurable. Any applicant required to submit Proof of Insurability is required to complete and submit to Us an Enrollment/Change form and such additional forms as we may require. Upon receipt of any required forms, We will review the applicant's responses to determine if the applicant is insurable under our underwriting rules then in place and, for the amount and type of coverage selected. In order to determine if the applicant is insurable, We may need to obtain and review the applicant's:

- Medical history, prescription history, and records relating to treatment, diagnostic testing, hospitalization and the like;
- Financial records and information; and
- Records pertaining to the applicant's driving and motor vehicle history.

No coverage requiring Proof of Insurability will become effective unless and until it is approved by Us in writing. Our receipt of any premiums associated with coverage requiring Proof of Insurability does not waive or modify any requirement that must be satisfied for coverage to begin, including but not limited to the requirement that the Applicant submit Proof of Insurability. In the event that any premiums are overpaid, Our only obligation is to return the amount of overpaid premiums.

B400.7822

Reasonable Accommodation: This term means any modification or adjustment that the Employer willingly provides to:

- A job;
- An employment practice;
- A work process; or the work place.

The modification or adjustment must make it possible for a Disabled person to:

- Reach the same level of performance as a similarly situated non-disabled person; or
- Enjoy equal benefits and privileges of employment as are available to a similarly situated non-disabled person.

The modification or adjustment must not place an undue hardship on the Employer.

B400.0274

Recurring Disability: This term means a later Disability that:

- Is related to an earlier Disability for which this Certificate paid benefits; and
- Meets the conditions described in the Recurring Disability section of this Certificate.

B400.0275

Regular and Appropriate Care: This term means, with respect to Your disabling condition(s) and any other condition(s) which, if left untreated, would adversely affect Your disabling condition, You:

- Visit a Doctor as frequently as medically required, according to generally accepted medical standards, to effectively manage these conditions; and
- Are receiving the most appropriate treatment, according to generally accepted medical standards, designed to achieve maximum medical improvement in these conditions.

Treatment must be provided by a Doctor or Doctors whose specialty is most appropriate according to generally accepted medical standards for You:

- Disability; and
- Any other conditions which left untreated would adversely affect Your disabling condition.

Generally accepted medical standards are those supported by nationally recognized authorities in the health care field including:

- The American Medical Association (AMA);
- The AMA Board of Medical Specialties;
- The Food and Drug Administration;
- The Centers for Disease Control;
- The National Cancer Institute;
- The National Institutes of Health;
- The Department of Health and Human Services; and
- Any other agency of similar repute.

B400.0276

Rehabilitation Agreement: This term means a formal agreement between:

- You;
- Us; and
- Your Employer, if needed.

It outlines the Rehabilitation Program in which You agree to take part.

B400.0277

Rehabilitation Program: This term means a program of work or job-related training for You that We approve in writing. Its aim is to restore Your wage earning abilities.

B400.0278

Short Term Disability: This term means the Short Term Disability income coverage described in the Policy and this Certificate.

B400.0283

Sickness: This term means an illness or disease. Pregnancy is treated as a Sickness under this Certificate.

B400.0284

Spouse: This term means the person to whom You are legally married, as recognized and allowed by federal law, or state law in Your state of residence or the state in which the marriage was recorded.

B400.0492

We, Us and Our: These terms mean The Guardian Life Insurance Company of America.

B400.0286

Week: This term means, during the Elimination Period, a consecutive 7 day period.

B400.0287

Weekly Benefit: This term means this Certificate's Gross Weekly Benefit reduced by other income. If You are Working While Disabled, Your Weekly Benefit will be further reduced based on the amount of Your Disability Earnings.

B400.0288

Working While Disabled: This term means You are working and earning a gross monthly income of 20% or more of Insured Earnings.

B400.0290

You or Your: These terms mean the covered Employee.

B400.0291

SHORT TERM DISABILITY INCOME COVERAGE SCHEDULE OF BENEFITS

The Guardian Life Insurance Company of America

10 Hudson Yards
New York, New York 10001
(212) 598-8000

Effective January 1, 2021 this Schedule of Benefits is attached to the Certificate. This Schedule of Benefits replaces any previously issued Schedule of Benefits.

Initial Election

When You first become eligible for this Certificate You must choose to become covered for one of the plans described below and pay the required premium.

You may request to change to another plan at any time. If You do this outside of the group enrollment period (see Conditions of Eligibility for more information), We will require Proof of Insurability before You change to another plan which provides greater benefits. You must notify the Employer of any desired change and pay the required premium. The increase in coverage will not take effect until We approve the change in writing.

B440.0042

Elimination Period For Disability due to Injury 7 days
During Disability

For Disability due to Sickness 7 days

B400.0632

Maximum Payment For Disability due to Injury 13 weeks
Period For Each
Disability

For Disability due to Sickness 13 weeks

B400.0635

Gross Weekly You may choose any one of the benefit amounts listed below which does not
Benefit exceed 60% of Your Insured Earnings. You must notify the Employer of Your election and pay the required premium.

You may change to another benefit amount at any time. If You do this outside of the group enrollment period (see Conditions of Eligibility for more information), We will require Proof of Insurability before You change to a higher benefit amount. See below for details. You must notify the Employer of any desired change and pay the required premium. The increase in coverage will not take effect until We approve the change in writing.

Plan ID A \$100.00

Plan ID B \$200.00

Plan ID C \$300.00

Plan ID D \$400.00

Plan ID E \$500.00

B440.0044

Annual Election After You first enroll for Short Term Disability, You may apply to increase Your Gross Weekly Benefit by selecting the next higher amount from the plan You elected as shown above. This option is available during the Short Term Disability enrollment period as provided by Your Employer. Proof of Insurability will not be required unless the insurance amount exceeds the Gross Weekly Benefit for which Proof of Insurability is required as shown in the Proof of Insurability Requirements.

If Proof of Insurability is required and has been submitted and approved by Us, proof for additional increases will be required on the second anniversary of the approval date.

If Proof of Insurability is required and has been declined, You will not be eligible for additional increases without submitted Proof of Insurability for them.

B400.0651

Proof of Insurability Requirements Depending on the coverage sought, You may be required to supply proof that the person applying for coverage is insurable for the type and amount of coverage selected. This requirement is called Proof of Insurability. For purposes of this section, any person applying for coverage requiring Proof of Insurability is referred to as an "applicant."

To determine if the applicant is required to submit Proof of Insurability for the type and amount of coverage sought, please see below.

Any applicant required to submit Proof of Insurability must complete and submit to Us an acceptable Enrollment/Change form. We may also require the completion of additional forms so that we may determine whether the applicant is insurable, according to Our underwriting standards for the type and amount of insurance for which the applicant applied. To determine if the applicant is insurable, We may also need to obtain and review the applicant's:

- Health and medical history;
- Prescription history;
- Records relating to treatment;
- Diagnostic testing;
- Hospitalization and the like; and
- Records pertaining to the applicant's driving and motor vehicle history.

No coverage requiring Proof of Insurability will become effective unless and until it is approved by Us in writing. Our receipt of any premiums associated with coverage requiring Proof of Insurability does not waive or modify any requirement that must be satisfied for coverage to begin, including but not limited to the requirement that the applicant submit Proof of Insurability. In the event that any premiums are overpaid, Our only obligation is to return the amount of overpaid premiums.

The Employer, or its designee, must give Us complete and accurate information so that we may determine:

- Who is insured;
- The type and amount of coverage for which someone is insured; and
- Any other information required so that Guardian may meet its obligations under the Certificate.

We require Proof of Insurability as follows:

If Your Active Work ends before You meet any Proof of Insurability requirements that apply, You will still have to meet those requirements if You are later re-employed by the Employer or an associated company within 30 days.

Any level of coverage that requires Proof of Insurability takes effect on the date We approve that proof in writing. But, You must be Actively At Work on that date. If You are not, the new level of coverage will take effect on the date You return to Active Work. In any case, the new level of coverage will not apply to a Recurring Disability.

B440.0914

Changes To Coverage

Changes In Coverage Amounts If You are not Actively At Work, any change in Your amount of coverage will not become effective prior to the date You return to Active Work.

Changes In Insurance Classification If Your classification changes, coverage will not be changed to the new amount until the first day on which You are: (1) Actively At Work; and (2) make a contribution, if required, for the new classification.

If a contribution is required for the new classification for which a larger amount of coverage is provided, You must make the required contribution for the new amount within 31 days of the change. If You do not make the required contribution within 31 days of the change or within 31 days of becoming Actively At Work, if You are not Actively At Work, when Your classification changes, no increase will be allowed due to such change or any later change. In that case, in order to become covered for the larger amount, You must:

- Make the required contribution for the new amount; and
- Furnish Proof of Insurability to Us, which We approve in writing.

If the coverage amount was previously reduced because of age or retirement, it will be retained at the reduced amount.

B440.0108

SUPPLEMENTAL RIDERS

B400.1022

CERTIFICATE RIDER

This Rider is effective as of the effective date of the Employee's Certificate. If this Rider is added to an inforce Certificate, the Rider becomes effective on its issue date. This Rider amends the Certificate by the addition of the following:

Specified Injury Benefit Rider

We pay a benefit for a guaranteed minimum number of Weekly Benefit payments due to a Specified Injury. What We pay is subject to the terms shown below, and to all the other terms of the Certificate.

When and How This Rider's Specified Injury Benefit Becomes Payable:

To receive payment under this Rider, You must meet all the conditions shown below:

- You must suffer a Specified Injury which occurs while You are covered by this Rider; and
- The Specified Injury must occur within 90 days of the date of the accident; and
- You must provide proof from Your Doctor of a Specified Injury; and
- You must survive the Certificate's Elimination Period.

What We Pay: If You meet the conditions stated above We pay a Weekly Benefit based on the Table of Specified Injuries shown below.

For covered multiple Specified Injuries due to the same accident, payments will be made for the loss with the greatest number of Weekly Benefit payments.

The amount We pay is determined as shown in the Calculation of Weekly Benefit provision in the Short Term Disability Income Coverage section of the Certificate. We pay a lump sum based on the guaranteed number of Weekly Benefit payments.

If You remain Disabled after We have made the guaranteed minimum number of Weekly Benefit payments, Weekly Benefits may continue subject to all the terms of the Certificate.

Table of Specified Injuries

**For Complete Fracture
of Bones:**

Number of Weekly Benefit Payments

Skull (except bones of face or nose), both tables	13
Thigh (shaft)	12
Arm, between elbow and shoulder (shaft)	12
Pelvis (except coccyx)	10
Vertebra or Vertebrae (except coccyx and vertebral processes)	10
Shoulder blade	8

Leg (shaft)	8
Kneecap	8
Collar bone	6
Forearm, between wrist and elbow (shaft)	6
Foot (except toes)	5
Hand (except fingers)	5
Lower jaw (except alveolar process)	3
One or more ribs, fingers or toes	2
Bones of face or nose	2
Coccyx or Vertebral Processes	1

For Complete Dislocation: Number of Weekly Benefit Payments

Hip Joint	12
Knee Joint (except patella)	6
Bone or Bones of Foot (except toes)	6
Ankle Joint	6
Wrist Joint	5
Elbow Joint	4
Shoulder Joint	3
Bone or Bones of Hand (except fingers)	2
Collar Bone	2
One or more fingers or toes	1

For Loss by Removal: Number of Weekly Benefit Payments

Of one or more entire toes	8
Of one or more entire fingers (at least one entire phalanx)	6

Definitions

This section defines certain terms appearing in this Rider. Additional terms, not listed here, are defined in the Certificate.

Specified Injury or Specified Injuries: These terms mean an Injury shown in the Table of Specified Injuries which is:

- Due to an accident; and
- Occurs while You are covered by this Rider.

This Rider is a part of the Certificate. Except as stated in this Rider, nothing contained in this Rider changes or affects any other terms of the Certificate.

The Guardian Life Insurance Company of America

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "M Prestileo", with a stylized flourish at the end.

Michael Prestileo, Senior Vice President

B400.0539

STATEMENT OF ERISA RIGHTS

The Guardian Life Insurance Company of America
10 Hudson Yards
New York, New York 10001
(212) 598-8000

Your group Short Term and/or Long Term Disability Income benefits may be covered by the Employee Retirement Income Security Act of 1974 (ERISA). If so, you are entitled to certain rights and protections under ERISA.

ERISA provides that all plan participants shall be entitled to:

**Receive Information
about Your Plan and
Benefits**

- (a) Examine, without charge, at the plan administrator's office and at other specified locations, such as worksites and union halls, all documents governing the plan, including insurance contracts and collective bargaining agreements, and a copy of the latest annual report (Form 5500 Series) filed by the plan with the U. S. Department of Labor and available at the Public Disclosure Room of the Employee Benefits Security Administration.
- (b) Obtain, upon written request to the plan administrator, copies of documents governing the operation of the plan, including insurance contracts, collective bargaining agreements and copies of the latest annual report (Form 5500 Series) and updated summary plan description. The administrator may make a reasonable charge for the copies.
- (c) Receive a summary of the plan's annual financial report. The plan administrator is required by law to furnish each participant with a copy of this summary annual report.

**Prudent Actions by
Plan Fiduciaries**

In addition to creating rights for plan participants, ERISA imposes duties upon the people who are responsible for the operation of the employee benefit plan. The people who operate the plan, called "fiduciaries" of the plan, have a duty to do so prudently and in the interest of plan participants and beneficiaries. No one, including your employer, your union, or any other person may fire you or otherwise discriminate against you in any way to prevent you from obtaining a welfare benefit or exercising your rights under ERISA.

**Enforcement of
Your Rights**

If your claim for a welfare benefit is denied or ignored, in whole or in part, you have a right to know why this was done, to obtain copies of documents relating to the decision without charge, and to appeal any denial, all within certain time schedules (see Claims Procedures below).

Under ERISA, there are steps you can take to enforce the above rights. For instance, if you request a copy of plan documents or the latest annual report from the plan and do not receive them within 30 days, you may file suit in a state or Federal court. In such a case, the court may require the plan administrator to provide the materials and pay you up to \$110.00 a day until you receive the material, unless the materials were not sent because of reasons beyond the control of the administrator. If you have a claim for benefits which is denied or ignored, in whole or in part, you may file suit in a federal court. If it should happen that plan fiduciaries misuse the plan's money or if you are discriminated against for asserting your rights, you may seek assistance from the U.S. Department of Labor, or you may file suit in a Federal court. The court will decide who should pay court costs and legal fees. If you are successful, the court may order the person you sued to pay these costs and fees. If you lose, the court may order you to pay these costs and fees, for example, if it finds that your claim is frivolous.

Assistance with Questions

If you have questions about the plan, you should contact the plan administrator. If you have questions about this statement or about your rights under ERISA, or if you need assistance in obtaining documents from the plan administrator, you should contact the nearest office of the Employee Benefits Security Administration, U.S. Department of Labor listed in your telephone directory or the Employee Benefits Security Administration, U.S. Department of Labor, 200 Constitution Avenue N.W., Washington D.C. 20210. You may also obtain certain publications about your rights and responsibilities under ERISA by calling the publications hotline of the Employee Benefits Security Administration.

Disability Benefits Claims Procedure

If you seek benefits under the plan you should complete, execute and submit a claim form. Claim forms and instructions for filing claims may be obtained from The Guardian Life Insurance Company of America (hereinafter referenced as Guardian).

Guardian is the Claims Fiduciary with authority to interpret and construe the terms of the Policy, the Certificate, the Schedule of Benefits, and any riders, or other documents or forms that may be attached to the Certificate or the Policy, and any other plan documents. Guardian has authority to determine eligibility for benefits and coverage under those documents. Guardian has the right to secure independent professional healthcare advice and to require such other evidence as needed to decide your claim.

In addition to the basic claim procedure explained in your certificate, Guardian will also observe the procedures listed below. These procedures are the minimum requirements for benefit claims procedures of employee benefit plans covered by Title 1 of ERISA.

Definitions

"Adverse determination" means any denial, reduction or termination of a benefit or failure to provide or make payment (in whole or in part) for a benefit.

Timing for Initial Benefit Determination

The benefit determination period begins when a claim is received. Guardian will make a benefit determination and notify a claimant within a reasonable period of time, but not later than the maximum time period shown below. A written or electronic notification of any adverse benefit determination must be provided.

Guardian will provide a benefit determination not later than 45 days from the date of receipt of a claim. This period may be extended by up to 30 days if Guardian determines that an extension is necessary due to matters beyond the control of the plan, and so notifies the claimant before the end of the initial 45-day period. Such notification will include the reason for the extension and a date by which the determination will be made. If prior to the end of the 30-day period Guardian determines that an additional extension is necessary due to matters beyond the control of the plan, and so notifies the claimant, the time period for making a benefit determination may be extended for up to an additional period of up to 30 days. Such notification will include the special circumstances requiring the extension and a date by which the final determination will be made.

A notification of an extension to the time period in which a benefit determination will be made will include an explanation of the standards upon which entitlement to a benefit is based, any unresolved issues that prevent a decision of the claim, and the additional information needed to resolve those issues.

If Guardian extends the time period for making a benefit determination due to a claimant's failure to submit information necessary to decide the claim, the claimant will be given at least 45 days to provide the requested information. The extension period will begin on the date on which the claimant responds to the request for additional information.

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**Adverse Benefit
Determination**

If a claim is denied, Guardian will provide a notice that will set forth:

- The specific reason(s) for the adverse determination;
- References to the specific provisions in the Policy, Certificate, plan or other documents, on which the determination is based;
- A description of any additional material or information necessary to perfect the claim and an explanation of why such material or information is necessary;
- A description of the plan's claim review procedures which a claimant may follow to have a claim for benefits reviewed and the time limits applicable to such procedures;
- A statement disclosing any internal rule, guideline, protocol or similar criterion relied on in making the adverse benefit determination (or a statement that such information will be provided free of charge upon request); or a statement that no internal rule, guideline, protocol or similar criterion was relied upon in making the adverse benefit determination;
- If applicable, an explanation of the basis of disagreement with or not following the views presented by you, of health care professionals who treated you and vocational professionals who evaluated you;

- If applicable, an explanation of the basis for disagreeing with or not following the views of any medical or vocational expert whose advice was obtained on our behalf in connection with the adverse benefit determination, without regard to whether the advice was relied upon in making the determination;
- If applicable, an explanation of the basis for disagreeing with or not following a disability determination made by the Social Security Administration that you present to us;
- A description of the plan's review procedures and the time limits applicable to such procedures, including a statement of the claimant's right to bring a civil action under ERISA Section 502(a) following an adverse benefit determination on appeal, and;
- In the case of an adverse benefit determination based on medical necessity or experimental treatment, notice will either include an explanation of the scientific or clinical basis for the determination, or a statement that such explanation will be provided free of charge upon request.

Appeal of Adverse Benefit Determinations If a claim is wholly or partially denied, the claimant will have up to 180 days to make an appeal. Guardian will conduct a full and fair review of an appeal which includes providing to claimants the following:

- The opportunity to submit written comments, documents, records and other information relating to the claim;
- The opportunity, upon request and free of charge, for reasonable access to, and copies of, all documents, records and other information relevant to the claim; and
- A review that takes into account all comments, documents, records and other information submitted by the claimant relating to the claim, without regard to whether such information was submitted or considered in the initial benefit determination.

In reviewing an appeal, Guardian will:

- Provide for a review conducted by a named fiduciary who is neither the person who made the initial adverse determination nor that person's subordinate;
- In deciding an appeal based upon a medical judgment, consult with a health care professional who has appropriate training and experience in the field of medicine involved in the medical judgment;
- Identify medical or vocational experts whose advice was obtained in connection with an adverse benefit determination; and
- Ensure that a health care professional engaged for consultation regarding an appeal based upon a medical judgment shall be neither the person who was consulted in connection with the adverse benefit determination, nor that person's subordinate.

Guardian will notify the claimant of its decision not later than 45 days after receipt of the request for review of the adverse determination. This period may be extended by an additional period of up to 45 days if Guardian determines that special circumstances require an extension of the time period for processing and so notifies the claimant before the end of the initial 45-day period.

A notification with respect to an extension will indicate the special circumstances requiring an extension of the time period for review, and the date by which the final determination will be made.

In the event Guardian denies the appeal of an adverse benefit determination, it will:

- Provide the specific reason or reasons why the appeal was denied;
- Refer to the specific provisions in the Policy, Certificate, plan, or other documents on which the benefit determination is based;
- Provide a statement that the claimant is entitled to receive, upon request and free of charge, reasonably access to, and copies of all documents, records, and other information relevant to the claimant's claim for benefits;
- Provide a statement disclosing any internal rule, guideline, protocol or similar criterion relied on in making the adverse benefit determination (or a statement that such information will be provided free of charge upon request); or a statement that no internal rule, guideline, protocol or similar criterion was relied upon in making the adverse benefit determination;
- If applicable, provide an explanation of the basis of disagreement with or not following the views presented by you, of health care professionals who treated you, and vocational professionals who evaluated you;
- If applicable, provide an explanation of the basis for disagreeing with or not following the views of any medical or vocational expert whose advice was obtained on our behalf in connection with the adverse benefit determination, without regard to whether the advice was relied upon in making the determination;
- If applicable, provide an explanation of the basis for disagreeing with or not following a disability determination made by the Social Security Administration that you present to us;
- Provide a statement describing the claimant's right to bring a civil suit under Section 502(a) of the Employee Retirement Income Security Act of 1974 which shall also describe any applicable contractual limitations period that applies the claimant's right to bring such an action, including the calendar date on which the contractual limitations period expires for the claim, and;

- In the event the adverse benefit determination is based on a medical necessity or experimental treatment or similar exclusion or limit, provide either an explanation of the scientific or clinical judgment for the determination, applying the terms of the plan to the claimant's medical circumstances, or a statement that such explanation will be provided free of charge upon request.

Alternative Dispute Options The claimant and the plan may have other voluntary alternative dispute resolution options, such as mediation. One way to find out what may be available is to contact the local U.S Department of Labor Office and the State insurance regulatory agency.

In addition to any legal rights you may have under section 502(a), if you believe that we have violated ERISA's procedural requirements, you may request that we review any claimed violation(s) and we will respond to you within ten days.

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SUMMARY PLAN DESCRIPTION SUPPLEMENT TO CERTIFICATE

You participate in a single or multiple employer insured Welfare Plan. This supplement and your certificate of insurance together may constitute the Summary Plan Description as required by the Employee Retirement Income Security Act of 1974 (ERISA). This supplement should be retained with your certificate.

- **Name of Plan:**

AMERICAN EMPLOYERS ALLIANCE Plan

- **Employer's Name:** (Plan Sponsor)

AMERICAN EMPLOYERS ALLIANCE

Address: 126 COLLEGE STREET SUITE 400A
BURLINGTON VT 05401

Phone Number: 205-972-0125

- If you participate in a multiple employer insured Welfare Plan, you may obtain a complete list of the employers sponsoring the plan upon written request to the plan administrator. You may also receive information as to whether a particular employer is a plan sponsor, and if the employer is a plan sponsor, the sponsor's address.

- **IRS Employer Identification Number (EIN):**464497693

- **Plan Number:** 501

- **Type of Administration:**contract administration

- **Plan Administrator:** (if other than Plan Sponsor)

AMERICAN EMPLOYERS ALLIANCE

Address: 126 COLLEGE STREET SUITE 400A
BURLINGTON VT 05401

Phone Number: 205-972-0125

- **Agent for the Service of Legal Process:**

AMERICAN EMPLOYERS ALLIANCE

Address: 126 COLLEGE STREET SUITE 400A
BURLINGTON VT 05401

Phone Number: 205-972-0125

(Legal process may also be served on the Plan Administrator.)

- If the plan is maintained pursuant to one or more collective bargaining agreements, the following information may be obtained by participants and beneficiaries upon written request to the plan administrator, and is available for examination by participants and beneficiaries: a copy of any such collective bargaining agreement; a complete list of the employers and employee organizations sponsoring the plan; and information as to whether a particular employer or employee organization is a sponsor of the plan, and if so, the sponsor's address. For the purpose of this paragraph, a plan is maintained pursuant to a collective bargaining agreement if such agreement controls any duties, rights or benefits under the plan, even though such agreement has been superseded in part for other purposes.
- **Date of End of Record Year:** January 1st .
- **Sources of Contribution:**Contributions to the plan are provided by:
 - the Employer
 - the Employee
 - Both the Employer and the Employee (assuming there are situations where both contribute).
- A class or classes of full-time employees are eligible to apply for insurance provided they have completed the service waiting period established by the employer, if any. Qualified dependents of these employees may also be eligible for insurance. (Your certificate provides details.)
- Participants and beneficiaries under this Plan can obtain, without charge, a copy of procedures governing qualified domestic relations order (QDRO) determinations from the plan administrator.
- **Termination/Amendment/Elimination:**Conditions may exist in the Group Policy where the plan sponsor or others have the authority to terminate the plan, amend or eliminate benefits under the plan. Please see the Plan Administrator for more information regarding these specific conditions and to request a copy of the Group Policy.
- **Assistance:** For information regarding rights under ERISA, contact the nearest office of the Employee Benefits Security Administration, U.S. Department of Labor, listed in the telephone directory, or the Division of Technical Assistance and Inquiries, Employee Benefits Security Administration, U.S. Department of Labor, 200 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Washington, D.C. 20210.

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YOUR BENEFITS INFORMATION - ANYTIME, ANYWHERE

www.guardianlife.com

You can access helpful, secure information about your Guardian benefits online 24 hours a day, 7 days a week.

Anytime, anywhere you have internet access, you'll be able to:

- Review your benefits
- Look up coverage amounts
- Check the status of your claim
- Print forms and plan materials
- And so much more!

To register, go to **www.guardianlife.com**

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**The Guardian Life Insurance
Company of America**
10 Hudson Yards
New York, New York 10001

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